

"I know I **have** the **body** of a **weak**, feeble **woman** but I **have** the **heart** and **stomach** of a **king**."

ELIZABETH I, AT TILBURY BEFORE THE ATTACK OF THE SPANISH ARMADA, AUGUST 9, 1588

RALLYING HER TROOPS

Elizabeth I ruled England from 1558-1603, her unmarried status leading to her nickname of the "Virgin Queen." Unlike Mary I, her predecessor, Elizabeth was a Protestant. Her persecution of Catholics led Mary's husband, Phillip II of Spain, to launch the Spanish Armada in July 1588, in the hope of overthrowing Elizabeth and restoring Catholicism to England. In August that year, the queen herself gave a rousing speech to her troops in which she promised to live or die along with her men. After a surprising English victory, Elizabeth's popularity rose, and *The Armada Portrait* (right) was painted to celebrate her success.

